

Advent Wreath Reading

Week One: The Candle of Hope

READER ONE:

Today marks the beginning of the celebration of Advent, the four Sundays prior to Christmas Day. Today, we begin the lighting of the candles of the Advent wreath that serves as a reminder of Christ's coming to redeem the world by bringing light to darkness. The lighting of this wreath each week is one of the ways that we prepare for the coming of the Lord.

READER TWO:

The wreath is covered with evergreen branches that have been a symbol of everlasting life found throughout the centuries. They are arranged in a circle to reflect that God is from everlasting to everlasting, without beginning and without end.

The candles remind us of Christ and that He is the LIGHT that has come into the world. The purple candles speak of His royalty and the one pink candle symbolizes our joy in Christ. The large, white candle in the center represents the purity of Christ Himself. Each week during Advent, we will light an additional candle as we anticipate celebrating the birth of Jesus. Then, when Christmas comes, all of the candles will be lit, including the center candle, as we proclaim that Christ has come, and that He is Immanuel, God with us.

READER ONE:

The season of Advent begins with a longing. We look around our world and see brokenness, uncertainty, and places where we desperately need God to come near.

The prophet Isaiah cries out, “O that you would tear open the heavens and come down!” Advent reminds us that we are not alone in our longing. We wait for the God who hears our cries, who remembers us, and who comes to meet us.

READER TWO:

Today we light the first candle, the candle of Hope. (*Light the first candle.*) As we light this candle, we pray for the courage to wait, the faith to trust, and the hope to believe that God is still coming. Jesus is coming: Prepare the Way!

Come, Lord Jesus. Prepare our hearts for your coming.